

Religious Review Brief — Good Measure Giving Educational Guides

Good Measure Giving

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REVIEW

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What we are asking of you

Good Measure Giving is a charity-evaluation website for Muslim donors. We have drafted seven educational guides that touch zakat and sadaqah. **None of them is published.** They are held back until reviewers with religious training confirm that what they say is accurate, fairly attributed, and appropriately humble about scholarly disagreement.

We are **not** asking you to issue fatwas, endorse the site, or resolve disputed questions. We are asking three questions of each guide:

1. **Accuracy** — Is anything stated as fact that is wrong, or stated as consensus that is actually disputed?
2. **Attribution** — Where we name a school's or scholar's position (Hanafi holds X, the majority holds Y), is the attribution correct?
3. **Framing** — Do we stay on the right side of the line between *explaining positions* and *issuing rulings*? Our editorial rule: the site verifies facts (e.g., "this charity publicly states it accepts zakat") and reports scholarly positions with their sources; it never renders a fiqh verdict. Every guide carries a "not a fatwa — consult a scholar you trust" disclaimer.

If a passage fails any of the three, we want the specific sentence and what's wrong with it. Suggested rewording is welcome but not required.

Our editorial stance (context for your reading)

- Guides present **broadly held positions in Sunni fiqh** and name the four schools where they differ.
- Where contemporary bodies differ (e.g., AMJA vs. the Fiqh Council of North America on retirement accounts), we name both.

- Every fiqh-bearing guide ends with a **Sources & further reading** section. The drafting process verified each citation against the source itself (including Qaradawi's *Fiqh al-Zakah*, AMJA fatwas, FCNA papers, NZF methodology, IslamQA, and the fatwa collection behind UNHCR's Refugee Zakat Fund). Please flag any source you consider inappropriate to rely on, and any authority you believe should be added.
- The site's charity tag **ZAKAT-ELIGIBLE** means exactly one verifiable thing: *the charity publicly states that it accepts zakat*. It is not our judgment that the charity's programs satisfy any school's criteria, and the guides repeat this.

The seven guides and what most needs your eyes

GUIDE 2 — HOW TO EVALUATE A MUSLIM CHARITY

Mostly secular due-diligence (IRS filings, governance, evidence). The fiqh-adjacent claims to check:

- Administrative costs from zakat under the **amilin** category: we say a portion is permitted by many scholars, note the Shafi'i one-eighth cap, and note that whether private charities qualify as amilin is debated.
- FAQ advice that uncertain-eligibility giving is better done as **sadaqah rather than zakat**.

GUIDE 3 — THE TOP ZAKAT-ELIGIBLE CHARITIES OF 2026

A list of ten real US charities that publicly accept zakat, top scorers within each cause area on our evaluation. Check:

- Is the "**publicly claims zakat acceptance, not a fiqh verdict**" framing maintained throughout, including the charity blurbs?
- Our characterization of **education** and **civil-rights/advocacy work** as disputed zakat categories — fairly stated?
- Anything in this page that, in your view, functionally amounts to a fatwa despite the disclaimers.

GUIDE 4 — SADAQAH VS ZAKAT

- The list of rules attaching to zakat only (nisab, hawl, 2.5%, the eight asnaf, niyyah).
- **Zakat al-fitr**: we state the majority day's-surplus standard and note the Hanafi nisab-surplus condition.
- **Niyyah**: that donations generally cannot be re-designated as zakat retroactively.

- Sadaqah to non-Muslims permitted; zakat to non-Muslims more restricted (majority view, muallafa exception).

GUIDE 5 — THE NISAB EXPLAINED

- 85g gold / 595g silver (noting some bodies use 87.48g/612.36g); dollar figures (~\$13,000 gold, ~\$1,000 silver at 2026 prices).
- The **gold-vs-silver benchmark debate** — we present both cases and disclose that our calculator displays the gold nisab. Is the presentation balanced? Is displaying gold as the default defensible if clearly labeled?
- **Mid-year dips**: Hanafi endpoints-only vs. majority interruption.
- **Debt deduction** “under the majority view” (noting the relied-upon Shafi’i position differs).
- Per-person (not household) assessment.

GUIDE 6 — THE COMPLETE ZAKAT PLANNING GUIDE

- Practical guidance to **fix an estimated zakat anniversary** when the true crossing date is unknown.
- **Advance payment** permitted by most schools, Maliki stricter.
- **Missed zakat** treated as a non-expiring debt, with guidance to estimate honestly.
- **Relatives**: parents/children excluded; husband-to-wife prohibited; wife-to-husband disputed with majority permitting.
- **Minor’s wealth**: majority levy, Hanafi does not.

GUIDE 7 — HOW TO BUDGET YOUR GIVING

Mostly financial structure. Check:

- “Zakat is the floor, not the ceiling” framing.
- **Ramadan reward** described as “widely held to be multiplied” (we deliberately avoided stating a multiplication factor as settled fact); the **Dhul-Hijjah ten days** hadith reference.
- FAQ: mosque membership is generally **not** zakat; mosques funded from sadaqah (majority view as we state it).

GUIDE 8 — WHO RECEIVES ZAKAT? THE 8 CATEGORIES

The most fiqh-dense guide; please read it in full. Specific load-bearing claims:

- The exclusivity reading of *innama* in 9:60.
- **Fuqara/masakin**: sufficiency vs. nisab tests varying by school; orphan eligibility flowing from poverty, not orphanhood.

- **Amilin**: classical appointment-by-authority presumption; the one-eighth cap attributed to the Shafi'i school (a position the other schools did not adopt); several fatwa bodies preferring zero deduction (the UNHCR model).
- **Muallafa**: lapse held by the Hanafi and Maliki schools (following Umar's practice); active per Shafi'i/Hanbali and most contemporary scholarship.
- **Riqab** applied to trafficking victims and captives.
- **Gharimin** conditions (permissible-purpose debt, genuine inability).
- **Fi sabilillah**: we state the restrictive view as the classical majority and present the expansive contemporary view (Qaradawi, AMJA, and the bodies they cite) as a genuine, live disagreement.
- **Ibn al-sabil** applied to refugees and the displaced (we cite the fatwa collection behind UNHCR's Refugee Zakat Fund).
- **Distribution**: majority permit one category; Shafi'i classically required covering locally present categories.
- The three charity cards: do their descriptions stay on the right side of "the organization describes its work as..." rather than our ruling?

Also in scope, already live (flag anything concerning)

- **Guide 1, "Zakat Eligibility: What It Means and How We Handle It"** — published since April 2026; included in the packet's scope on request.
- **Zakat calculator pages** (cash, gold/silver, stocks, 401k/retirement, crypto, business assets, real estate) — live calculation tools with brief fiqh explainers and consult-your-scholar notes. The retirement page presents the deferral view and the annual-on-accessible view, noting AMJA deducts penalties while FCNA's default method does not.

How to respond

Per finding, the most useful form is:

Guide N, section "...", sentence "..." — what's wrong (accuracy / attribution / framing) — suggested fix (optional).

A simple "no objection" per guide is equally valuable. Differences of opinion between reviewers will be resolved conservatively (we hold or reword rather than publish over an objection).

JazakumAllahu khairan for your time and care.